

BONUS 7 OF 7

# 150 de jocuri fără tipărire

150 No-Print Classroom Games — oral and interactive activities for all levels, no printing and no prep.

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## How to use this book

Pick a game, read the 3–5 steps and play. Every game needs no printing and no preparation: just your voice, the board, or the room.

## Games 1–5

### 1 Hot Seat

All levels · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Split the class into two teams and place one chair facing the team with its back to the board.
2. Write a word on the board; the team describes it without saying it while the seated student guesses.
3. Score a point for each correct guess in 60 seconds, then swap teams.

**Variation:** Allow only one-word clues for advanced classes.

### 2 Bomb Game

All levels · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Choose a topic such as animals or past tense verbs.
2. Students pass an imaginary bomb around the circle, saying a word on the topic each turn.
3. Count down secretly; whoever holds the bomb when you shout Boom is out.

**Variation:** Make the topic harder each round, such as words ending in -tion.

### 3 Simon Says

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Stand in front of the class and give commands starting with Simon says.
2. Students obey only commands that start with those words.
3. Anyone who moves on a command without them sits down; the last student standing leads next.

**Variation:** Let students lead and use prepositions of place as commands.

### 4 Chain Story

All levels · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Sit students in a circle and start a story with one sentence.
2. Each student adds one sentence in turn, repeating nothing already said.
3. Stop after everyone has spoken and retell the story together.

**Variation:** Require each sentence to begin with the last word of the previous one.

### 5 Freeze Drama

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Two volunteers start acting out a scene suggested by the class.
2. At any moment you shout Freeze and a new student taps one actor out.
3. The newcomer takes the same pose but starts a completely different scene.

**Variation:** Give a required line each newcomer must include.

## Games 6–10

### 6 Just a Minute

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Give a student a topic and ask them to speak for one minute.
2. They must not hesitate, repeat words or deviate from the topic.
3. Classmates call out any mistake and take over the topic for the remaining time.

**Variation:** Reduce the time to 30 seconds for lower levels.

### 7 Shark Tank

C1 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Each group invents a product or service in two minutes.
2. Groups pitch to a panel of student sharks in a one-minute speech.
3. Sharks ask two tough questions and then decide whether to invest.

**Variation:** Pitch an absurd product that nobody needs.

### 8 Word Tennis

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Choose a category such as food or jobs.
2. Partners volley words in that category back and forth like a tennis ball.
3. The one who hesitates, repeats a word or goes off topic loses the point.

**Variation:** Change the category after every five points.

### 9 Four Corners

All levels · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Label the four corners of the room A, B, C and D or with four opinions.
2. Read a statement or question and give students ten seconds to walk to a corner.
3. Each corner explains its choice to the class in a sentence.

**Variation:** Use degrees of agreement from strongly agree to strongly disagree.

### 10 Quick Debate

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Announce a motion such as Homework should be banned.
2. Assign sides at random and give two minutes of preparation.
3. Each side speaks for one minute and the class votes on the winner.

**Variation:** Switch sides halfway and argue the opposite view.

## Games 11–15

### 11 Alibi

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Two students leave the room as suspects in an imaginary crime.
2. Together they invent a detailed alibi for the previous night.
3. The class interviews each suspect separately and spots any contradiction.

**Variation:** Make the interrogators guess the time of the crime.

### 12 Never Have I Ever

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students hold up five fingers.
2. Take turns saying something you have never done, starting Never have I ever.
3. Anyone who has done it folds a finger and tells a short story about it.

**Variation:** Limit statements to travel or food topics.

### 13 Snowball Fight

All levels · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students think of a question or sentence and mime scrunching an imaginary paper snowball.
2. On your signal they throw it and another student catches it and answers the question aloud.
3. Continue until everybody has answered at least twice.

**Variation:** Answer in the third person as if reporting.

### 14 Human Bingo

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Write nine facts on the board such as has a pet or likes tea.
2. Students mingle asking questions to find a different person for each fact.
3. The first student to find someone for every fact shouts Bingo.

**Variation:** Ask students to remember a follow-up detail for every person.

### 15 Describe Without Saying

All levels · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. One student faces the board and the other faces the class.
2. Write a word on the board; the describer explains it without saying it.
3. The guesser has 45 seconds to name it, then partners swap.

**Variation:** Add three taboo related words that cannot be used.

## Games 16–20

### 16 Twenty Questions

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. One student thinks of an object, person or place.
2. The group asks up to twenty yes or no questions to find it out.
3. The guesser who solves it thinks of the next one.

**Variation:** Allow only questions in the past tense.

### 17 Running Dictation Aloud

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Divide the class into teams with a runner and a writer.
2. Say a sentence at the front of the room in a low voice.
3. The runner whispers it to the writer, who says it aloud to the team; first accurate team wins.

**Variation:** Use longer sentences each round.

### 18 Twenty Seconds

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Name a topic and a student must speak about it for twenty seconds.
2. The partner counts silently and notes any pauses or repeated words.
3. Swap roles and compare how smooth each talk was.

**Variation:** Increase the time to forty seconds.

### 19 Odd One Out

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say four words aloud, three from one group and one different.
2. Students decide which is the odd one out and explain why.
3. Take turns and let students create their own sets.

**Variation:** Create sets where more than one answer is possible.

### 20 Story Cubes Classroom

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: Classroom objects

1. Each group picks five objects from the classroom and puts them out of sight.
2. Name them and the group invents a story that includes all five.
3. Groups tell their story to another group.

**Variation:** Add one emotion that must run through the story.

## Games 21–25

### 21 Fizz Buzz English

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students count in a circle, one number each.
2. Replace multiples of three with Fizz and multiples of five with Buzz.
3. A student who makes a mistake sits out; continue to a target number.

**Variation:** Replace the numbers with colours or days of the week.

### 22 Yes No Challenge

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. One partner asks quick personal questions.
2. The other must answer without saying yes, no or shaking the head.
3. Count how many questions they survive in one minute and swap.

**Variation:** Also ban the words maybe and perhaps.

### 23 Mime the Verb

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. A student secretly receives a verb whispered by you.
2. They mime it while teammates call out guesses in full sentences such as You are swimming.
3. The correct guesser mimes the next verb.

**Variation:** Mime adverbs as well, such as sadly or quickly.

### 24 Two Truths and a Lie

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Each student prepares three statements about themselves.
2. They say them aloud to the group in any order.
3. Teammates question and vote on which one is the lie.

**Variation:** Use statements about a famous person.

### 25 Backs to the Board

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Two students sit with their backs to the board.
2. Write a word on the board and the team explains it without saying it.
3. The first sitting student to say the word scores a point.

**Variation:** Use full phrases or idioms.

## Games 26–30

### 26 Alphabet Race

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Pick a category such as countries.
2. The first student says a word beginning with A, the next with B and so on.
3. If someone cannot think of one in five seconds the group restarts.

**Variation:** Go backwards from Z.

### 27 What Am I

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Whisper a role or object to a student, such as a teacher or a bus.
2. The class asks yes or no questions to discover what they are.
3. Limit to ten questions before revealing the answer.

**Variation:** Students answer as the object in the first person.

### 28 Sentence Auction

C1 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Say ten sentences aloud or write them on the board, some correct and some with errors.
2. Teams spend imaginary money bidding on the sentences they think are correct.
3. Reveal answers; correct sentences earn the bid, wrong ones lose it.

**Variation:** Teams must correct the wrong sentences to win back money.

### 29 Telephone Whispers

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students stand in a line; you whisper a sentence to the first student.
2. Each student whispers it to the next without repeating it.
3. The last student says it aloud and the class compares with the original.

**Variation:** Use tongue twisters.

### 30 Taboo Teams

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Write a target word and three forbidden words on the board.
2. One student describes the target without the forbidden words.
3. Their team has one minute to guess; score each success.

**Variation:** Describe the target in only three sentences.

## Games 31–35

### 31 Pass the Story

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Begin a story with a dramatic first line.
2. Throw an imaginary ball to a student who continues it in one sentence.
3. They throw it to someone else and the story continues for three minutes.

**Variation:** Each speaker must use a given linking word.

### 32 Spot the Mistake

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Tell a short story with deliberate mistakes in facts or grammar.
2. Students raise a hand when they hear one.
3. The student who spots it corrects it and tells the next story.

**Variation:** Insert only tense errors.

### 33 Rapid Fire Questions

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students stand in pairs facing each other.
2. One asks as many questions as possible in one minute on a given topic.
3. The other answers briefly; swap and compare numbers.

**Variation:** Ask only open questions beginning with why or how.

### 34 Desert Island

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Tell groups they are stranded on an island and can keep only five items.
2. Each member proposes one item with a reason.
3. The group agrees on the final five and presents.

**Variation:** Add a rule that items must start with the same letter.

### 35 Reporter and Celebrity

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. One student is a famous person chosen secretly.
2. The partner interviews them with ten questions.
3. The interviewer guesses the identity at the end.

**Variation:** Interview a fictional character.

## Games 36–40

### 36 Silent Line Up

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students must line up by birthday or age without talking.
2. Allow only gestures and fingers.
3. When finished each says their date aloud to check.

**Variation:** Line up by height or alphabetical first names in English.

### 37 Opinion Line

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Make an imaginary line from strongly agree to strongly disagree.
2. Read a statement and students stand where they feel.
3. Pairs from opposite ends explain their position.

**Variation:** Rank statements from least to most important.

### 38 Reverse Charades

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. One team acts out a phrase together while a single guesser watches.
2. The guesser must say the phrase in full.
3. Rotate guessers and track the fastest time.

**Variation:** Use film titles or proverbs.

### 39 Word Association Chain

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. The first student says any word.
2. The next says a word they associate with it.
3. Anyone who repeats or hesitates for five seconds is out.

**Variation:** Each word must rhyme with the previous one.

### 40 Past or Present Challenge

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a verb in present simple.
2. The next student answers with its past form within three seconds.
3. Wrong answers lose a life; groups have three lives.

**Variation:** Use participles instead of simple past.

## Games 41–45

### 41 Mingle Survey

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Give everyone one question to ask by heart, like What do you do at weekends?
2. Students walk around and ask at least five classmates.
3. Report the most surprising answer to the class.

**Variation:** Report using reported speech.

### 42 Guess My Job

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. A student mimes a job without speaking.
2. The group asks yes or no questions about the job.
3. Whoever guesses mimes the next job.

**Variation:** Add the workplace and the tools used.

### 43 Headline Race

C1 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a short news event aloud.
2. Teams invent a catchy headline in thirty seconds.
3. The class votes on the best headline.

**Variation:** Rewrite the headline in a different style, such as tabloid.

### 44 Argue the Opposite

C1 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Give a controversial statement and let each partner choose a stance.
2. Partners must argue the stance opposite to their real opinion for two minutes.
3. Switch stances and compare which arguments were easiest.

**Variation:** Add a signal word that must appear in every argument.

### 45 Rhyme Time

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a word and the group must find as many rhyming words as possible in a minute.
2. Each rhyme counts one point; no repeats allowed.
3. Move on to a new word with a harder ending.

**Variation:** Build a four-line rhyming poem aloud.

## Games 46–50

### 46 Spelling Bee Oral

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Divide the class into two lines.
2. Say a word and the first student spells it aloud letter by letter.
3. A mistake sends the student to the back of the line; the last line standing wins.

**Variation:** Spell words backwards.

### 47 Imaginary Shopping

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. One student is a shop assistant and the other a customer.
2. Choose a shop and have a short exchange asking for items and prices.
3. Swap roles and choose a new shop.

**Variation:** Customer must complain about something.

### 48 Time Machine

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Tell groups they can visit any time period for one day.
2. Each member says where they would go and why.
3. The group chooses one and presents it to the class.

**Variation:** Plan what to bring using conditionals.

### 49 Count the Words

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Give a topic and a number, such as seven words.
2. Each partner must say a sentence about the topic with exactly that many words.
3. Swap, raising the number each round.

**Variation:** Use only words of one syllable.

### 50 Missing Person

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students close their eyes while one student quietly leaves the room or hides.
2. Open eyes and ask the class to describe the missing classmate in full sentences.
3. The class guesses who is missing.

**Variation:** Describe the clothes only.

## Games 51–55

### 51 Grammar Relay

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Divide the class into teams and name a grammar point, for example past simple.
2. The first student in each team says one correct sentence using it.
3. The next student must say a different sentence, and so on down the line.
4. A team scores a point for every correct sentence; a repeat or a mistake ends that team's turn.

**Variation:** Require each sentence to start with the last word of the previous one.

### 52 Pronunciation Chain

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a word with a tricky sound, such as 'three'.
2. The next student repeats it and adds a new word with the same sound.
3. Each student must repeat the whole chain before adding a word.
4. If the chain breaks, start again with a new target sound.

**Variation:** Chain words with the same sound in different spellings, like 'through' and 'blue'.

### 53 Minimal Pairs Race

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Write a minimal pair on the board, such as ship / sheep.
2. Say one word aloud without moving your lips too much.
3. Teams decide which word they heard and the first student to shout it gets a point.
4. Rotate speakers so students can also be the one who says the word.

**Variation:** Students make up sentences that contain both words of the pair.

### 54 Verb Tense Ladder

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Draw a ladder with five rungs on the board and give a base sentence, for example 'I eat breakfast'.
2. Each team climbs by saying the sentence in the next tense: past, future, present perfect, past continuous.
3. If a team makes an error, they slide down one rung.
4. The first team to reach the top rung with correct sentences wins.

**Variation:** Climb through the tenses with a negative sentence, then a question.

### 55 Opposites Ping-Pong

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. One student says a word, such as 'hot'.
2. The partner answers immediately with the opposite, 'cold', and then gives a new word.
3. Keep the rally going as fast as possible without hesitation.
4. A student who hesitates or repeats a word loses the point.

**Variation:** Play with synonyms instead of opposites.

## Games 56–60

### 56 Rhyme Time

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a word, for example 'cat'.
2. Going around the group, each student gives a rhyming word.
3. If a student cannot think of one in five seconds, they sit out.
4. The last student standing starts a new round with a new word.

**Variation:** Each rhyming word must also be part of a short sentence.

### 57 Whisper Dictation

A1-A2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Teams stand in lines and the teacher whispers a sentence to the first student of each line.
2. Students whisper it down the line to the last person.
3. The last student says the sentence aloud and the teacher compares it with the original.
4. Points go to the team with the closest and most correct version.

**Variation:** Use longer sentences or tongue twisters as the message.

### 58 Find the Mistake

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a sentence aloud that contains one grammar mistake.
2. Students raise a hand when they hear the error.
3. The student chosen says the mistake and the correction.
4. Let students take turns as the speaker, inventing sentences with hidden errors.

**Variation:** Include two mistakes in each sentence.

### 59 Question Tennis

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A asks a question on any topic.
2. Student B answers in one short sentence and immediately asks a new question.
3. Continue like a tennis rally without pausing.
4. If someone repeats a question or loses the thread, the other student scores.

**Variation:** Each question must begin with a different question word.

### 60 Categories Rush

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Write a category on the board, such as 'things in a kitchen'.
2. Teams take turns calling out an item within five seconds.
3. No repeats are allowed, and the team that cannot answer is out of the round.
4. The last team in wins the category; then pick a new one.

**Variation:** Add a letter constraint: every item must start with the same letter.

## Games 61–65

### 61 Alphabet Vocabulary Sprint

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Choose a topic, for example animals.
2. Students go around the class naming an animal for each letter of the alphabet, A to Z.
3. If a student is stuck, they can pass once to a classmate.
4. Try to finish the alphabet before a time limit set by the teacher.

**Variation:** Go backwards from Z to A.

### 62 Word Association Loop

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. The first student says a word, for example 'ocean'.
2. The next student says a word associated with it, and must explain the link when challenged.
3. Continue until someone hesitates or repeats a word.
4. Begin again with a new starting word.

**Variation:** Each new word must be a different part of speech.

### 63 Stress Detective

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Write several multi-syllable words on the board.
2. Say a word, deliberately putting the stress on the wrong syllable or the right one.
3. Students clap once if the stress is correct and stomp if it is wrong.
4. The student who answers correctly then becomes the speaker.

**Variation:** Students stand up on the stressed syllable and sit on the others.

### 64 Silent Letters Hunt

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Say a word with a silent letter, such as 'knife' or 'castle'.
2. Groups discuss and decide which letter is silent.
3. One member of each group writes the letter on the board.
4. Groups earn a point for each correct answer; the teacher then reveals the spelling.

**Variation:** Groups must think of their own words with a silent letter for the others to guess.

### 65 Preposition Treasure Map

A1-A2 · pairs · 10-15 min · Materials: A board

1. Draw a simple grid on the board and mark a hidden treasure square secretly.
2. One student guides their partner using prepositions and directions, such as 'next to', 'between', 'behind'.
3. The partner draws the path on a notebook page or in the air and names the square.
4. Swap roles and choose a new treasure square.

**Variation:** Use only questions the guide may answer with yes or no.

## Games 66–70

### 66 Word Stress Orchestra

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a sentence slowly with natural rhythm.
2. The class repeats it, tapping or clapping on each stressed word.
3. Increase speed gradually so the rhythm becomes natural.
4. Ask volunteers to lead a new sentence with their own rhythm.

**Variation:** Change the stress to change the meaning of the sentence.

### 67 Past Tense Stories in Pairs

A1-A2 · pairs · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Student A says a sentence about yesterday using a regular or irregular past verb.
2. Student B adds a related sentence in the past tense.
3. Keep going until each partner has said five sentences.
4. Pairs then share their best sentence with the class.

**Variation:** Alternate between positive and negative sentences.

### 68 Spell and Shout

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a word aloud and ask groups to spell it letter by letter together.
2. The first group to spell it correctly, in unison, scores a point.
3. If a group makes a mistake, they must start again.
4. Increase the difficulty with longer words.

**Variation:** Spell the word backwards.

### 69 Connected Speech Echo

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a phrase using natural connected speech, such as 'whaddya want'.
2. Students repeat exactly what they hear.
3. Then students say what the full written form is.
4. Repeat with new phrases, letting students suggest their own.

**Variation:** Students listen to a phrase and write it as they hear it on paper or in the air.

### 70 Quick Fire Comparatives

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A names two objects, for example 'a car and a bike'.
2. Student B must immediately make a comparative sentence using an adjective.
3. Next, Student B names two new objects for Student A.
4. Do not repeat an adjective; whoever repeats loses a point.

**Variation:** Move on to superlatives with three objects.

## Games 71–75

### 71 Word Ladder Voice

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Write a start word on the board, such as 'cold'.
2. Each student changes one letter to make a new word: 'cord', 'card', 'care'.
3. The student says the new word and spells it aloud.
4. The group that makes the longest chain without a repeat wins.

**Variation:** Set a target word and see who reaches it in the fewest steps.

### 72 Clap the Syllables

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a word and the class claps its syllables.
2. Ask a student to say how many syllables it has.
3. Next, students suggest their own words for the class to clap.
4. Add difficulty by choosing longer words or a topic category.

**Variation:** Students stand up for each syllable instead of clapping.

### 73 Number Dictation Race

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Teams line up facing the board.
2. Say a number, date or phone-style sequence aloud.
3. The first student in each line runs to write it on the board.
4. The first team with the correct number scores; then the next students come up.

**Variation:** Use prices, times, or dates with ordinals.

### 74 Reported Speech Whisper

B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Student A says a direct sentence to Student B, such as 'I am tired'.
2. Student B reports it to Student C: 'She said she was tired'.
3. Continue down the group, reporting each time.
4. Check whether the final report stays grammatically correct.

**Variation:** Use questions and commands as the original message.

### 75 Odd One Out Speaking

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say four words aloud, three from one category and one that does not belong.
2. Groups discuss and decide which word is the odd one out.
3. One student announces the word and explains why in a full sentence.
4. Rotate the role of the speaker each round.

**Variation:** Students invent their own sets of four for the other groups.

## Games 76–80

### 76 Echo Summary

B1-B2 · pairs · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Student A talks about their weekend for one minute.
2. Student B listens without taking notes.
3. Student B summarizes the key points in three sentences.
4. Student A says what was missed or wrong; then swap roles.

**Variation:** Student B must summarize using only reported speech.

### 77 Tongue Twister Showdown

All levels · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Teach one tongue twister and say it slowly with the class.
2. Groups practise the twister in whispers for one minute.
3. Each group performs it at full speed in front of the class.
4. The class votes for the clearest and fastest performance.

**Variation:** Groups invent a new tongue twister using a given sound.

### 78 Yes No Interrogation

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A thinks of a person, animal or object.
2. Student B asks only yes/no questions to guess it.
3. Student A answers with full short answers such as 'Yes, it is' or 'No, it isn't'.
4. Count questions; fewer questions wins the round.

**Variation:** Limit to ten questions in total.

### 79 Missing Word Murmur

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a sentence aloud but murmur or hum one word.
2. Students must guess the missing word.
3. The student who guesses repeats the whole sentence correctly.
4. That student then reads or invents the next sentence.

**Variation:** Murmur two words at once.

### 80 Collocation Catch

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A says a verb, such as 'make' or 'take'.
2. Student B immediately says a noun that collocates with it, such as 'a decision'.
3. Switch quickly, so Student B gives a verb and Student A the noun.
4. Score a point each time a partner cannot respond in five seconds.

**Variation:** Use adjective and noun combinations like 'heavy rain'.

## Games 81–85

### 81 Phrasal Verb Charades Aloud

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Teams take turns giving a clue for a phrasal verb without saying it.
2. The clue can be a definition or a short context sentence.
3. The other teams guess the phrasal verb.
4. Teams score a point for correct guesses and a bonus for good clues.

**Variation:** Clues must be given in exactly one sentence.

### 82 Conditionals Chain

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a first conditional sentence, for example 'If it rains, I will stay home'.
2. The next student uses the result as the new condition: 'If I stay home, I will watch a film'.
3. Continue around the group to build a chain of consequences.
4. If someone makes a grammar mistake, the chain restarts.

**Variation:** Use second conditionals with imaginary situations.

### 83 Memory Echo List

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Start with 'I went to the market and I bought an apple'.
2. The next student repeats the sentence and adds a new item.
3. Continue until a student forgets an item.
4. The student who forgot starts a new list with a different sentence.

**Variation:** Use a different place and different items for each round.

### 84 Fast Translation Duel

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A says a short phrase in their first language.
2. Student B must say the English equivalent as quickly as possible.
3. If the answer is correct, roles are reversed.
4. Keep a score in each pair.

**Variation:** Use idioms and ask the class to confirm if the English is natural.

### 85 Spot the Intonation

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Write the symbols for rising and falling intonation on the board.
2. Say sentences or questions with either intonation.
3. Students raise a hand high for rising and low for falling.
4. Discuss how each shows a different meaning or attitude.

**Variation:** Students say the same word as a statement, a question or a surprise.

## Games 86–90

### 86 Time Zone Questions

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A names a time and a city, for example 'It is nine o'clock in London'.
2. Student B guesses what a person might be doing and asks a question.
3. Student A answers in a full sentence in the present continuous.
4. Swap roles with a new time and place.

**Variation:** Use past continuous: what were they doing at that time yesterday?

### 87 Word Building Relay

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: A board

1. Write a root word on the board, such as 'happy'.
2. Teams take turns saying a derived word: 'happiness', 'unhappy', 'happily'.
3. Each word must also be used in a sentence.
4. A team that repeats or errs is out; the last team wins.

**Variation:** Focus on prefixes only, then suffixes only.

### 88 Listening Detective

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Tell a short story aloud with five specific details, such as names, numbers and places.
2. Groups listen without taking notes.
3. Ask questions about the details and groups answer in whispers.
4. Score a point for each correct detail.

**Variation:** Tell the story a second time with two changed details; students must spot them.

### 89 Fizz Buzz Grammar

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students count up around the circle.
2. On multiples of three, say a past tense verb instead of the number.
3. On multiples of five, say a plural noun.
4. A student who makes an error sits down.

**Variation:** Change the rules to adjectives and adverbs.

### 90 Taboo Talk

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. One student is the speaker and thinks of a target word and three words they cannot use.
2. The speaker describes the target word using other words only.
3. The group guesses the word within a minute.
4. Rotate speakers; the group with most correct guesses wins.

**Variation:** Use abstract nouns as target words.

## Games 91–95

### 91 Describe and Guess

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A thinks of an object in the classroom.
2. Student A describes it using colour, size, position and use.
3. Student B listens and guesses the object.
4. Swap roles and choose a different object.

**Variation:** Describe a place or a person instead of an object.

### 92 Pass the Sentence

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. The first student says the beginning of a sentence, such as 'Yesterday I...'.  
2. The next student repeats it and adds a word or phrase.
3. Continue until the sentence becomes long and strange.
4. Students then try to say the final sentence at full speed.

**Variation:** Each new word must start with the next letter of the alphabet.

### 93 Homophone Hunters

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: A board

1. Say a word that has a homophone, such as 'flower'.
2. Groups write down on paper or say the other word, 'flour'.
3. Then groups must use both words in a single sentence.
4. A point goes to the first group with a correct sentence.

**Variation:** Groups make a list of as many homophone pairs as they can in two minutes.

### 94 Stand Up Sit Down Grammar

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a sentence aloud.
2. If the grammar is correct, students stand up.
3. If it is incorrect, students stay seated or sit down.
4. Ask the students who were right to explain the correction.

**Variation:** Students use hand signals instead of standing.

### 95 Number of Words Challenge

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A is given a number, say seven.
2. Student A must say a meaningful sentence of exactly seven words.
3. Student B counts on their fingers and confirms.
4. Swap roles with a new number.

**Variation:** Add a required word that must appear in the sentence.

## Games 96–100

### 96 Accent Mimic

B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Demonstrate a short sentence in a clear neutral accent.
2. Students repeat it copying the rhythm and intonation.
3. Groups perform the same sentence with different emotions: angry, bored, excited.
4. The class guesses the emotion and comments on how intonation changed.

**Variation:** Use a different sentence per group and let others guess the emotion.

### 97 Quick Quiz Elimination

All levels · whole class · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. All students stand up.
2. Ask a question about vocabulary or grammar, such as 'What is the past of go?'.  
3. Those who answer incorrectly or too slowly sit down.
4. Continue until one student is left standing.

**Variation:** Students become the quiz masters in later rounds.

### 98 Story Ending Guess

C1 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Read the first two sentences of a short story aloud.
2. Groups discuss how it might end and use modal verbs of deduction.
3. Each group presents its guess: 'It must be...', 'It could be...'.  
4. Finish by telling the real ending and vote on the best prediction.

**Variation:** Each group invents the middle of the story instead of the end.

### 99 Debate Vocabulary Ladder

C1 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: A board

1. Write a topic on the board and three advanced words related to it.
2. Groups prepare a short argument using all three words correctly.
3. Each group speaks for thirty seconds.
4. The class awards points for accuracy and creativity of the vocabulary used.

**Variation:** Use a different set of words each round and include a connector to practise.

### 100 Sentence Stretch

All levels · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say a very short sentence, such as 'I run'.
2. Each student repeats it and stretches it by adding one word or phrase.
3. Continue around the class until the sentence is too long to remember.
4. The last student to say it correctly wins the round.

**Variation:** Only adjectives or adverbs may be added.

## Games 101–105

### 101 Mirror Mirror

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students face a partner. One is the person, the other is the mirror.
2. The person does slow actions and says what they are doing: 'I am brushing my teeth.'
3. The mirror copies the action and repeats the sentence.
4. Swap roles after one minute.

**Variation:** The mirror must say the sentence in the third person: 'She is brushing her teeth.'

### 102 Two Minute Tour Guide

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A closes their eyes and imagines a place they know well.
2. Student A guides Student B through it with directions and descriptions.
3. Student B asks questions and says what they 'see'.
4. Swap and compare which place was clearer.

**Variation:** Guide the partner through an imaginary place, such as a zoo on the moon.

### 103 The Last Word

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Groups of four stand in a circle. Give a topic, such as 'a perfect weekend'.
2. One student speaks for two sentences, then names the next speaker.
3. Each speaker must start by repeating the last word of the previous speaker.
4. Anyone who hesitates for more than three seconds sits down.

**Variation:** Speakers must start with the last word and add a connector such as 'however' or 'because'.

### 104 Whisper Down the Lane Plus

All levels · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Groups stand in lines. The first student gets a sentence whispered by you.
2. Each student whispers it to the next without repeating it.
3. The last student says it aloud and the group compares it with the original.
4. Give a longer sentence each round.

**Variation:** The last student must also act out the sentence.

### 105 Yes Yes No No

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. One student asks quick yes/no questions about their partner's life.
2. The partner must answer with a full sentence and never use the single words 'yes' or 'no'.
3. If they slip, they swap roles.
4. Play for three minutes and count slips.

**Variation:** Also ban the words 'maybe' and 'I think'.

## Games 106–110

### 106 Alphabet Travellers

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say 'I am going to Argentina and I will take an apple.'
2. The next student repeats it and adds a place and item with B.
3. Continue through the alphabet, each time repeating the full list.
4. If a student forgets, the group helps and the game continues.

**Variation:** Use a theme only, such as food or clothes, with no countries.

### 107 Air Painter

All levels · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A draws a simple object in the air with a finger.
2. Student B guesses by asking 'Is it a ...?'
3. Student A answers with 'Yes, it is' or 'No, it isn't, it is bigger.'
4. Swap after each object.

**Variation:** Draw in the air with an elbow or a foot.

### 108 Body Letters

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Call out a word and spell it slowly.
2. Students form each letter with their body or arms.
3. Students say the letter aloud while they make it.
4. Choose a student to call out the next word.

**Variation:** Groups of three make letters together with their bodies.

### 109 Would You Rather Walk

B1-B2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Mark the left of the room as option A and the right as option B.
2. Read a would-you-rather question aloud.
3. Students walk to their side and find a partner from the other side.
4. Pairs explain their choice and try to convince each other to switch.

**Variation:** Use a 'middle' corner for students who can't decide, who must justify it.

### 110 Lie Detector Pairs

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A tells a 30-second story, true or invented.
2. Student B asks three follow-up questions.
3. B decides if the story is true and says why.
4. Swap roles.

**Variation:** Student B can ask only yes/no questions.

## Games 111–115

### 111 Echo Stories

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A says one sentence about their day.
2. Student B repeats it, changes one detail, and says it again as a question.
3. Student A corrects the detail: 'No, I didn't ...'
4. Keep going for five exchanges.

**Variation:** Use the past tense only.

### 112 Speed Dating Questions

B1-B2 · whole class · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Students form two lines facing each other.
2. Give a topic and they chat with the person opposite for one minute.
3. On your signal, one line moves one step to the right.
4. Repeat with a new topic each round.

**Variation:** Each round, partners must find three things they have in common.

### 113 Silent Movie Narrator

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Groups of four. Two students act a scene in silence.
2. The other two narrate what is happening in a dramatic voice.
3. Narrators use past and present tenses as they like.
4. Groups swap roles and perform for another group.

**Variation:** Performers add one word only each time you clap.

### 114 Gossip Chain

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students stand in groups of five.
2. The first one tells a short rumour about a famous (invented) person.
3. Each student passes it on, adding one detail and changing the intensity.
4. The last student tells the group the final rumour and they vote on the most surprising.

**Variation:** Add a rule that every student must use a reported speech verb.

### 115 One Word Orchestra

All levels · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Choose a conductor.
2. Assign each group a word and a sound level: whisper, normal, shout.
3. The conductor points to groups and they say their word in the right volume.
4. Rotate the conductor and add new words.

**Variation:** The conductor uses hand signals for speed as well.

## Games 116–120

### 116 Reporter on the Street

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. One student is the reporter, the others are people on the street.
2. The reporter interviews three people about the topic of the day.
3. Interviewees answer with different opinions.
4. The reporter summarises results to the class.

**Variation:** The reporter can only ask open questions starting with 'why' or 'how'.

### 117 Move If

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students stand in a circle with no chair.
2. A student in the middle says 'Move if you ...' and completes a sentence about themselves.
3. Everyone who agrees swaps places quickly.
4. The student left without a place goes into the middle.

**Variation:** Use the present perfect: 'Move if you have ever ...'

### 118 Ten Second Description

All levels · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A looks around and chooses an object in the room.
2. A has ten seconds to describe it without naming it.
3. B guesses.
4. Swap and make the time shorter.

**Variation:** Describe a classmate instead of an object.

### 119 Opposite Day Speaking

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A says a sentence about themselves, such as 'I like coffee.'
2. Student B says the opposite: 'I don't like coffee.'
3. Then B adds a new sentence for A to reverse.
4. Keep a fast rhythm for two minutes.

**Variation:** Use opposite adjectives instead of negatives.

### 120 Story Dice in the Air

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Each student invents a pretend object and describes it in one sentence.
2. Groups put all objects in a story in order.
3. Each student adds a line to the story with their object.
4. Groups tell the finished story to another group.

**Variation:** Tell the story in reverse order.

## Games 121–125

### 121 Taboo Gestures

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Teams take turns sending one student to the front.
2. Whisper a word to that student.
3. They explain the word without saying it or any word that contains it.
4. The team scores a point for each guess in one minute.

**Variation:** The explainer can use only gestures.

### 122 Questions Only

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Two students start a conversation using questions only.
2. If either makes a statement or hesitates, they lose a life.
3. Each student has three lives.
4. Winners play a final round in front of the class.

**Variation:** Add a scene: a customer and a waiter.

### 123 Emotion Walk

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students walk around the room.
2. Call out an emotion: 'Happy!' or 'Angry!'
3. Students walk like that emotion and say 'I'm happy' to each classmate.
4. When you call 'Freeze', they explain why they feel that way.

**Variation:** Call out two emotions combined, such as 'nervous and excited'.

### 124 Sentence Auction

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: A board

1. Write ten sentences on the board, some correct and some with errors.
2. Groups have a pretend budget of 1000 and bid for the sentences they think are correct.
3. Reveal the answers and award money for correct sentences.
4. The richest group wins.

**Variation:** Groups must correct the wrong sentences to get a refund.

### 125 Fortune Tellers

A1-A2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A is a fortune teller and looks at B's hand.
2. A predicts three things using 'will': 'You will travel to Japan.'
3. B reacts: 'That's true!' or 'No way!'
4. Swap roles.

**Variation:** Predictions must include a time: 'next year', 'in five years'.

## Games 126–130

### 126 Cause and Effect Chain

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. The first student says a cause: 'It rained all day.'
2. The next adds an effect with 'so': 'So we stayed at home.'
3. The next uses that effect as a new cause.
4. Keep going until the chain reaches ten links.

**Variation:** Use 'because' and go backwards from the final result.

### 127 Statue Museum

All levels · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Each group builds a statue with their bodies that represents a word, such as 'freedom'.
2. The rest of the class walks through the 'museum'.
3. Visitors guess the title and ask the sculptors questions.
4. Sculptors answer in character as the 'artists'.

**Variation:** Statues come alive for ten seconds when you clap.

### 128 Zip Zap Boing

All levels · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students stand in a circle.
2. One points to another and says 'Zip'; that person must point to another and say 'Zap'.
3. 'Boing' makes the direction go back.
4. Replace the words with vocabulary from your lesson.

**Variation:** Replace the words with items from a category, such as animals.

### 129 Describe and Draw Blind

B1-B2 · pairs · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Student A thinks of a scene and describes it with prepositions.
2. Student B closes their eyes and 'paints' the scene in the air.
3. B retells what they painted.
4. A confirms or corrects the details.

**Variation:** Use a real photo from memory, such as a family trip.

### 130 Two Truths Mingle

B1-B2 · whole class · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Students think of two true statements and one false one.
2. They walk around and tell them to as many classmates as possible.
3. Classmates guess the false one and say why.
4. Count how many people each student fooled.

**Variation:** Make all three statements about the past.

## Games 131–135

### 131 Rapid Fire Categories

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Choose a category, such as 'things in a kitchen'.
2. Students pass an imaginary ball around the circle.
3. The student who catches it names an item in two seconds.
4. If someone repeats or hesitates, they step out.

**Variation:** Add a letter: items must start with 'S'.

### 132 Telephone Role Play

B1-B2 · pairs · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Students sit back to back.
2. Give them a situation, such as booking a table.
3. They have a phone conversation without seeing each other.
4. Switch the situation and partner.

**Variation:** Add a problem: the line is bad, so they must ask for repetition.

### 133 Debate Steps

C1 · whole class · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Read a controversial statement.
2. Students stand in a line from 'strongly agree' to 'strongly disagree'.
3. Each student speaks with the person next to them to defend their position.
4. They may move if they are convinced.

**Variation:** Reverse positions and defend the opposite view.

### 134 Elevator Pitch

C1 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students invent a product or a plan.
2. They have 30 seconds to pitch it to a partner.
3. The partner asks one tough question.
4. Swap and then vote for the best pitch.

**Variation:** Pitch to a different person each round in a mingle.

### 135 Odd One Out Aloud

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Say four words aloud, three connected and one different.
2. Groups decide the odd one and explain why.
3. Each group must give a different reason from the previous group.
4. Students then invent their own sets.

**Variation:** Four phrases or sentences instead of words.

## Games 136–140

### 136 Memory Shopping Race

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Teams line up.
2. The first student says 'In my bag I have a book.'
3. Each next student repeats and adds one object.
4. The team with the longest correct list wins.

**Variation:** Add adjectives to each item.

### 137 The Interrupting Storyteller

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. One student starts telling a story.
2. Others may shout 'Stop!' and add a twist.
3. The new speaker continues the story with the twist.
4. Limit each turn to 30 seconds.

**Variation:** The twist must use a given word such as 'suddenly'.

### 138 Guess My Job Mime

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. One student mimes a job.
2. The team asks yes/no questions: 'Do you work outside?'
3. The mime nods or shakes their head.
4. The team has one minute to guess.

**Variation:** The mime must also say one sentence about their day.

### 139 Hands Up Vocabulary Race

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Call out a category.
2. Students raise a hand and shout one word.
3. Each word can be used only once.
4. Students who run out of words sit down.

**Variation:** Use word families, such as words with the sound /s/.

### 140 The Perfect Excuse

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A is a teacher, student B is late for class.
2. B must give the most creative excuse possible.
3. A responds with doubt and questions.
4. Swap and vote on the best excuse.

**Variation:** The excuse must have three parts, all in the past.

## Games 141–145

### 141 Walk and Talk Line

B1-B2 · whole class · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Students form two lines facing each other.
2. Ask a question, such as 'What is your dream job?'
3. They discuss with their partner for one minute.
4. One line steps right and a new question begins.

**Variation:** One line must ask only follow-up questions.

### 142 Rhythm Chants

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Create a simple clapping beat.
2. Say a sentence rhythmically, such as 'I like pizza.'
3. The class repeats, then each student adds their own item.
4. Keep the beat steady while you go around the circle.

**Variation:** Make it a question and answer between two halves of the class.

### 143 Spot the Difference Story

B1-B2 · pairs · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Student A tells a short story.
2. Student B retells it but changes three details.
3. A listens and catches the changes.
4. Swap roles with a new story.

**Variation:** B changes details in a way that makes the story absurd.

### 144 Hot Air Balloon Debate

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Each group member chooses a person or job to represent.
2. The balloon is falling, and one person must leave.
3. Each student argues why they should stay.
4. The group votes and the last survivor wins.

**Variation:** Choose objects instead of people to argue for.

### 145 Instruction Chain

A1-A2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. The first student gives a command, such as 'Touch your nose.'
2. The next student does it and adds a command.
3. The third does both and adds a third.
4. Continue until someone forgets.

**Variation:** Use polite requests: 'Could you please ...'

## Games 146–150

### 146 Headline Tales

B1-B2 · groups · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Say a news headline aloud, such as 'Dog Drives Bus'.
2. Groups invent the full story and who is involved.
3. They present it as a news report to the class.
4. Others ask reporter-style questions.

**Variation:** Groups tell the story from the dog's point of view.

### 147 Imaginary Object Pass

All levels · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students stand in a circle.
2. One mimes an object and says what it is: 'This is a hot potato.'
3. The next student takes it, changes it into something else, and says what it is.
4. Continue around the circle.

**Variation:** Each student must describe how it feels: 'It's heavy and cold.'

### 148 Reverse Interview

C1 · pairs · 10-15 min · Materials: None

1. Student A answers first and B must guess the question.
2. For example A says 'Because it was the only option.'
3. B must produce the best question that fits.
4. Swap after three answers.

**Variation:** A gives a short story as the answer.

### 149 Number Story Mingle

A1-A2 · whole class · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Each student chooses a number that matters to them, such as an age or a date.
2. Students walk around and say the number to a partner.
3. The partner guesses what it is: 'Is it your birthday?'
4. After two guesses the student explains the real meaning.

**Variation:** Students swap numbers and tell the other person's story.

### 150 Pass the Opinion

B1-B2 · groups · 5-10 min · Materials: None

1. Students stand in a circle and you give a topic.
2. The first student gives an opinion with a reason.
3. The next must agree or disagree politely and add a new reason.
4. Keep going around the circle for two minutes.

**Variation:** Each student must use a different opinion phrase, such as 'In my view'.

#### NEXT STEP

## Put the games to work

Choose three games for this week and play one at the start of each class.

- 1 **Pick** one warm-up, one speaking game and one review game from this book.
- 2 **Play** them in the last ten minutes of your classes, or whenever energy drops.
- 3 **Repeat** the ones your students ask for again and use the variation to keep them fresh.